How to install PhoenixOS
Here's a useful guide that takes you through the process of installing PhoenixOS. **http://dgit.in/oct20-07**

Bluestacks emulator
If you're looking to play Android games and run apps on your PC, Bluestacks is the easiest way to go. **http://dgit.in/oct20-08**

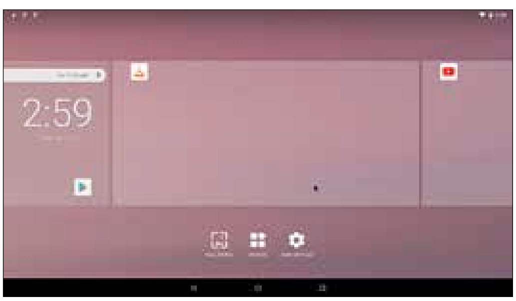
options which you can finetune to your preference. This particular AVD (Android Virtual Device) runs from within VirtualBox, which is a virtual machine software that you'll need to download and install in order to use Genymotion.

Genymotion's biggest draw is being able to simulate Android hardware functions. These include things like GPS, camera, SMS and calls, multi-touch support, and more. Cloud access through services like Amazon and Alibaba is also possible and there's also ADB access and support for various app testing frameworks.

Since this is a software targeted at developers, providing them with an environment in which to test their applications, it comes at a premium. There is however a free Personal Edition if you're looking to simply mess around.

ANDROID X86.ORG

Android -86.org is an open-source option to run Android on your PC, and since it's open-source, it's also free to use. It's an easy way to get the latest version of Android for your PC, be it to use it as your primary OS or on a virtual machine. The software comes with as close to stock Android as possible. It also has Google Play services installed by default. However, keep in mind that stock Android is made for touch surfaces, and the experience is much different on a desktop.



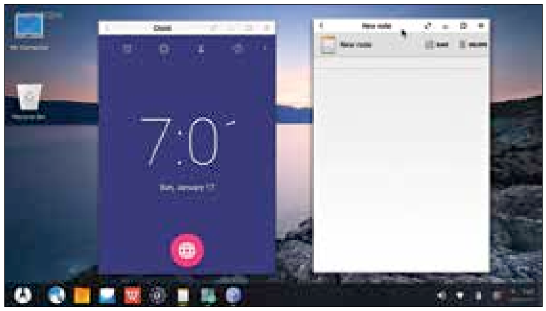
Installing Android x86 is slightly more complicated than anything we've touched upon so far. You'll need to first get a hold of the ISO of Android-x86, which you'll need to burn on to a disc or bootable USB stick. Then, you can decide whether you want to install Android OS on your harddrive or on a virtual machine. Like with Genymotion, you can simply use a VM like VirtualBox to access Android from within your desktop's OS.

The official guide to installing Android x86 can be found here: http://dgit.in/androidx86.

PHOENIX OS

Phoenix OS is an OS based on Android 7 that's designed for running on desktops and laptops. Like Android x86, you'll need to download the ISO for Phoenix and burn it onto a CD or bootable USB before installing it. Windows users can download a .exe file as well. Mac users will have to use the former method. You can choose to dual boot it along with your preferred OS, or use Phoenix as your primary OS.

Phoenix OS's interface looks very similar to Windows in terms of its looks, but it behaves like Android. If you're using a laptop with a touch display you can navigate just like you would on a tablet or smartphone. Phoenix comes with Google Play preinstalled. In addition to downloading apps directly from the Play Store, you can sideload them with APK files as well. This is possible on BlueStacks too.



GOOGLE ANDROID EMULATOR

Google's official Android Emulator comes as a part of the Android SDK. It allows you to run Android through a window on your existing OS. The intention is of course giving developers somewhere to test their apps.

However, while this is an option, it's comparatively slow when put next to previous options we've already touched upon in this article, which is why it's usually avoided.

ANDROID -IA

Android -IA is Intel's own distribution of Android for their new Intel-based PCs, which comes with UEFI firmware. Android on Intel Architecture, shortened to Android -IA, comes with its own installer to install on a Windows device, and gives you the option to dual boot alongside your Windows OS. This is a great option if you're not looking to run Android on a virtual machine, don't have the hardware to do so, or simply want to be able to switch between OSs.

As you can see, there are many ways to get Android running on your PC. However, a lot of them aren't exactly easy to use, or stable. Definitely not for casual users, but, if you know what you're doing and have the supported hardware, knock yourself out. If you don't, we recommend simply using BlueStacks. It's the easiest and user-friendliest of the lot, and makes using Android on PC as easy as possible, if you're simply looking to experience Android and not get into testing or developing.